

Silent Night, Holy Night

Text: Joseph Mohr, 1818;
tr. John Freeman Young, 1863
STILLE NACHT irregular

Music: Franz Gruber, 1818

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in 8/8 time. It consists of four staves of music. The first staff begins with a treble clef, a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat), and a common time signature of 8. The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing beamed eighth notes. The lyrics are written below the staff, with the first line in German and the subsequent lines in English. The second staff continues the melody, with a key signature change to two flats (B-flat, E-flat) and a common time signature of 8. The third staff continues the melody, with a key signature change to one flat (B-flat) and a common time signature of 8. The fourth staff concludes the piece with a key signature change to no flats (C major) and a common time signature of 8. The lyrics are written below the staff, with the first line in German and the subsequent lines in English.

1 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! All is calm, all is bright,
2 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Shep - herds quake at the sight,
3 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Son of God, love's pure light,
4 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Won - drous star, lend thy light,
round yon vir - gin moth - er and child, ho - ly In - fant, so ten - der and mild,
glo - ries stream from heav - en a - far, heav'n - ly hosts sing: "Al - le - lu - ia,
ra - diant beams from Thy ho - ly face, with the dawn of re - deem - ing grace,
with the an - gels let us sing, Al - le - lu - ia to our King,
sleep in heav - en - ly peace, sleep in heav - en - ly peace.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born."
Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born.